

ON TECHNIQUE

The Philip Glass Ensemble

After his return to New York in 1967, Glass wrote a large number of Minimalist pieces for small ensembles, usually featuring electric keyboards, amplified wind instruments, and solo voices. To perform these works, he gathered around him a group of musicians, which formally became the Philip Glass Ensemble in 1968. The number and combination of the ensemble's instruments varied from piece to piece, with a core of around 10 performers, including Glass himself. Several compositions—including the opera *Einstein on the Beach* (1975)—were written specifically with the Philip Glass Ensemble in mind.



THE PHILIP GLASS ENSEMBLE PERFORMING LIVE

Although often associated with the New York arts scene, Philip Glass was born and brought up in Baltimore. His father owned a record store in the city, which stocked a wide range of classical